

1799. Alexander von Humboldt sets out for Latin America, on an expedition that lays the groundwork for modern plant geography.

1845. Pierre-François Verhulst formulates an equation to predict population growth.

1880s. The earliest forms of ecological survey are conducted in studies of wild fish by Stephen A. Forbes.

1895. In showing how plants are related to their environments, Johannes Warming unites the fields of botany and ecology.

1898. Andreas Schimper shows how the link between a plant’s physiology and external conditions is key to plant ecology.

1899. The changing vegetation of sand dunes inspires Henry Chandler Cowles’ idea of primary